COVID-19 Global Impact - Executive Summary

Question: Did faster vaccination rollouts lead to a bigger drop in deaths?

Key insights

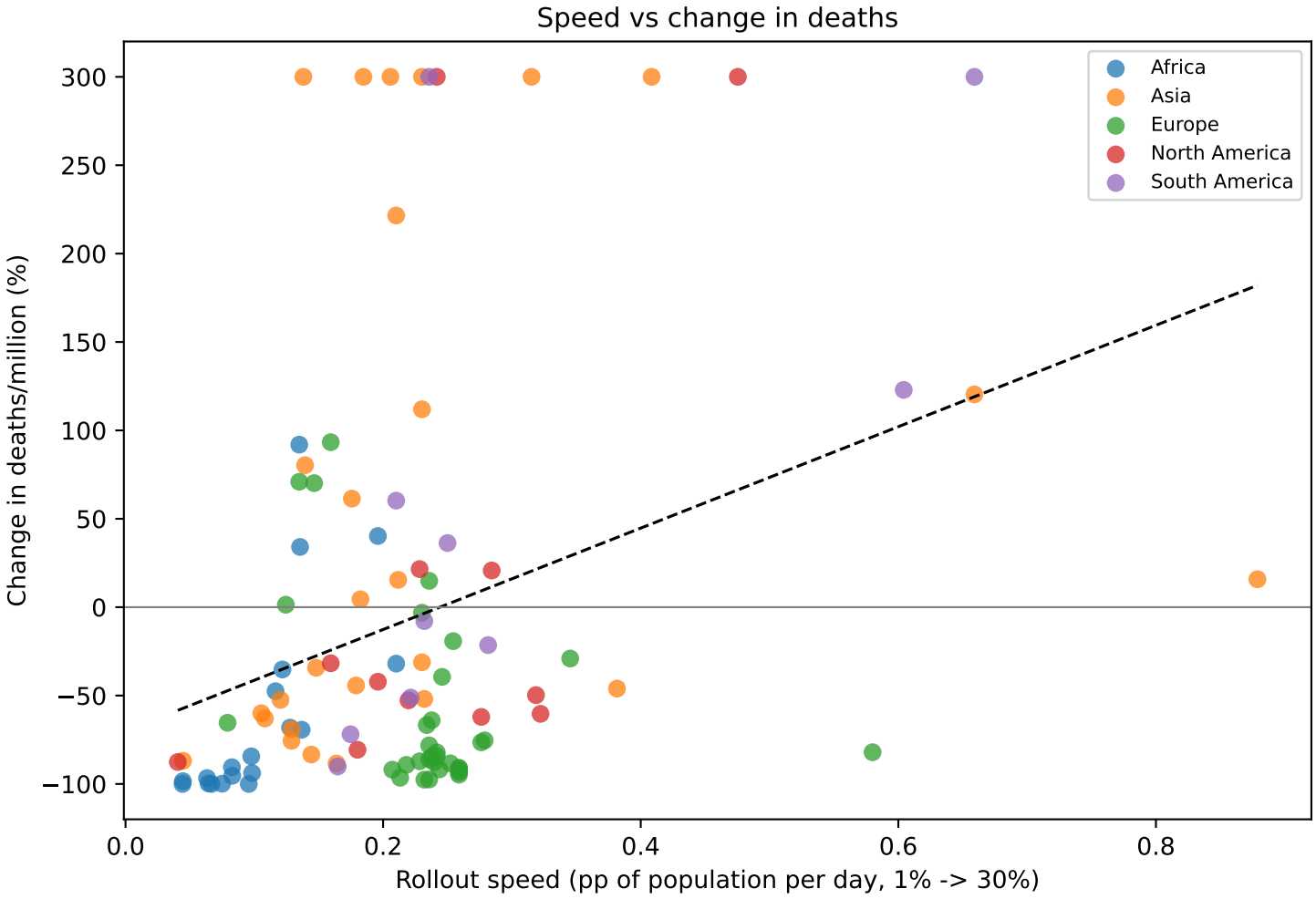
1. Out of 102 countries analysed, the correlation between rollout speed and change in deaths is 0.27 (the link is weak, so speed alone does not explain outcomes).

2. Faster-rollout countries changed deaths/million by a median of -52% vs -63% for slower ones.

3. Highest Resilience Index: Sweden (77/100). Lowest: Georgia (15/100).

4. Limitation: new variants (e.g. Omicron), age structure and testing differences also affect deaths, so this shows association, not proof of cause.

5. All numbers are per million people, so large and small countries compare fairly.



Data: Our World in Data. Method: 7-day averages, per-million normalisation, 90-day windows before/after rollout.